

JesusOnline Equip

Ministry Resources Hub

The Fast Lane to Ugliness

A free resource from JesusOnline Ministries.

Read or share online: app.jesonline.com/post/22220-010-the-fast-lane-to-ugliness

JesusOnline Equip · Ministry Resources Hub · equip.jesonline.com

Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

The Fast Lane to Ugliness

Charm is deceptive and beauty is fleeting, but a woman who fears the Lord is to be praised. (Proverbs 31:30)

False are charms and vain is the beauty of woman; for a prudent woman is blessed. Let her praise the fear of the Lord. (Proverbs 31:30, Septuagint)

Ah, Hollywood and the media biz. Is it not the world's "Beauty Obsession Center"? Cosmetic surgery. Endless makeovers. Outrageously priced clothing and hair care. Rodeo Drive and Fifth Avenue with "personal shoppers" who seduce the gullible with promises of everlasting attractiveness. It's where "You're looking beautiful" is said before "Hello."

As a person who's lived many decades, I discover that almost nobody refers to me as "handsome" or even "good-looking" anymore. The inevitable toll of the years whittles away at any natural, physical comeliness God may have given us. All the cosmetic efforts in the universe can't stop the whittling. Let's face it—physical ugliness is inevitable. Not many beautiful faces in nursing homes!

Proverbs calls physical attractiveness "fleeting." A sudden disfiguring accident or disease or stroke and all the effort invested in enhancing one's physical beauty can be turned into ugliness—in a nanosecond.

Principle: Obsession with personal appearance is an exercise in futility. Its benefits are short-lived and can be stolen in an instant.

God places emphasis on *inner* beauty. "Man looks at the outward appearance, but the Lord looks on the heart," says 1 Samuel 16:7. Show me a person with external comeliness and a bitter angry spirit, and I will show you a person on the fast lane to ugliness...externally as well as internally. Show me a person with a righteous, joyful, tranquil, gracious, loving spirit; and I will show you a person whose "attractiveness of spirit" will make you forget their lack of physical attractiveness.

Principle: The beauty of a person's character is the ultimate "cosmetic surgery" that creates loveliness through the ultimate "faith lift."

The word *cosmetics* is rooted in the Greek word *cosmos*; one meaning of which is “arrangement.” When cosmetics are applied, they are designed to alter the “arrangement” of the face or body—a purely surface alteration. When the face is reflecting the beauty of the inner spirit, its attractiveness is rooted deep within... where aging cannot reach.

Principle: To improve your appearance dramatically, get a “spiritual makeover.”

A spiritual makeover may cost you dearly, but it won’t be in dollars. It’ll be in confessed...and forgiven...sins.

[from “[Wisdom for the Trenches](#)” by Dr. Larry W. Poland]

Thank you for downloading this free resource!

We're grateful you've taken this step in your spiritual journey. Your growth in Christ encourages us, and we pray this has been a blessing—strengthening your faith, deepening your understanding of God's Word, and equipping you to live for His glory.

Share Your Thoughts

Your feedback helps us improve future resources and encourages others:

Leave a Review or Send Us a Note — If you found this helpful, please consider leaving a short review. Your honest words make a big difference! We love hearing how God is using these materials in your life.

Share Your Story → equip.jesonline.com/reviews/share

Discover More Free Resources

Continue growing in your walk with Jesus. Here are additional tools from the JO EQUIP library and JesusOnline Ministries:

- **Explore the Free Books** → equip.jesonline.com/books
- **Download the Free JO App** — Your personal discipleship hub with the NET Bible, daily devotions, interactive studies, prayer tools, more books, and videos. [Download for Android](#) · [Download for iOS](#) · Explore in browser → app.jesonline.com
- **Watch Video Playlists** → equip.jesonline.com/playlists
- **Visit JesusOnline Ministries** — For more about this ministry and global outreach: jesonlineministries.org

Would you like to help others? Share this resource (or the download link) with friends, your small group, or your church. Every copy planted can bear eternal fruit!

Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

Apologetics • Evangelism • Discipleship • Equipping